



Imagine an insect so cleverly disguised that you might mistake it for a twig. This is not a scene from a fantasy movie but a real-life creature known as the Australian walking stick. These fascinating creatures are long and slender, often brown or green, and perfectly blend into their surroundings. With their six legs, antennae and body that looks like a stick, they can fool even the keenest eyes.



Now, you might be wondering where these sneaky critters live. Australian walking sticks, as their name suggests, are found in Australia, in the wild outback, and lush rainforests. They love hanging out on leaves and branches, which is not surprising considering their diet. They are herbivores, feasting on a variety of leaves, especially eucalyptus.

From being a tiny egg to a full-grown adult, the life cycle of Australian walking sticks is quite remarkable. A female lays her eggs in the branches of trees, and when they hatch, out pops a mini walking stick, called a nymph. These nymphs grow by shedding their skin, a process called molting. After several molts, the nymphs mature into adults with fully developed wings.

While we've seen how they live and grow, their relationship with other creatures is equally fascinating. Humans might find them intriguing because of their unique look and harmless nature. In the animal world though, they have a neat trick to avoid becoming dinner for birds and lizards - they play dead! This, along with their stick-like appearance, makes them different from most other insects.



So next time you're exploring the outdoors, keep an eye out for these masters of disguise. Remember, they might be closer than you think, munching on leaves or pretending to be a twig. From their diet and habitat to their unique defenses and life cycle, Australian walking sticks are truly one-of-a-kind creatures. Who knew that nature's most incredible magic shows could be performed by a creature as simple as a stick insect?



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What color can an Australian walking stick be?
A. blue or yellow B. black or white
C. brown or green D. red or purple
- 2) What happens when a nymph of an Australian walking stick grows?
A. They dig a hole and hibernate for a year.
B. They split into two and become twins.
C. They grow feathers and learn to fly.
D. They shed their skin, a process called molting.
- 3) What do Australian walking sticks eat?
A. blood B. insects C. nectar D. leaves
- 4) Where does a female Australian walking stick lay her eggs?
A. In nests made of leaves. B. In the branches of trees.
C. In holes in the ground. D. In water bodies like ponds.
- 5) What does the Australian walking stick look like?
A. Long and slender, often brown or green.
B. Short and stubby, often red or blue.
C. Large and bulbous, often black or white.
D. Small and round, often pink or yellow.
- 6) Where are Australian walking sticks found?
A. Antarctica B. Alaska C. Australia D. Africa
- 7) Which word best describes Australian walking sticks?
A. herbivores B. carnivores C. omnivores D. insectivores
- 8) What is a baby Australian walking stick called?
A. a nymph B. a pup C. a cub D. a larva
- 9) What animals eat Australian walking sticks?
A. Dogs and cats. B. Cows and goats.
C. Birds and lizards. D. Bears and coyotes.
- 10) Do Australian walking stick have wings?
A. yes only nymphs B. yes only males
C. yes only adults D. yes only females

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "To keep safe from birds and lizards, I pretend to be dead. And guess what? It works!"
- 12) "My favorite place to live is in the wild outback and the rainforests."
- 13) "Despite my name, I do not live in Australia."





49) Australian Walking Sticks can't fly like some other stick insects.

- | | |
|-------------|-----------|
| A. can | B. could |
| C. will not | D. cannot |

50) It's tough to spot them because of their amazing camouflage.

- | | |
|-------------|-----------|
| A. It is | B. It was |
| C. It could | D. It has |

51) They're herbivores and love to eat eucalyptus leaves.

- | | |
|-------------|--------------|
| A. They do | B. They were |
| C. They are | D. They have |

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

52) Australian walking sticks are not harmful to humans.

53) The way Australian walking sticks regenerate their lost limbs during molting is absolutely incredible!

54) Australian walking sticks have long, thin bodies that resemble sticks or twigs.

55) Are Australian walking sticks insects?

56) Do Australian walking sticks have wings?

57) It's unbelievable how perfectly Australian walking sticks can camouflage with their environment!

58) Australian walking sticks feed on leaves and plants.

59) What do Australian walking sticks eat?

60) It's amazing that Australian walking sticks can grow up to 8 inches long!



Australian Walking Stick

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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Australian Walking Stick

Name: _____

1.	C	26.	Would	51.	C
2.	D	27.	fact	52.	declarative
3.	D	28.	opinion	53.	exclamatory
4.	B	29.	fact	54.	declarative
5.	A	30.	opinion	55.	interrogative
6.	C	31.	fact	56.	interrogative
7.	A	32.	opinion	57.	exclamatory
8.	A	33.	fact	58.	declarative
9.	C	34.	fact	59.	interrogative
10.	C	35.	opinion	60.	exclamatory
11.	Would	36.	opinion		
12.	Would	37.	true		
13.	Not	38.	false		
14.	Would	39.	true		
15.	Would	40.	false		
16.	Would	41.	true		
17.	Not	42.	false		
18.	Would	43.	false		
19.	Would	44.	false		
20.	Not	45.	true		
21.	Not	46.	true		
22.	Would	47.	B		
23.	Would	48.	A		
24.	Not	49.	D		
25.	Not	50.	A		